

function calling

Function calling is a ability that allows LLMs to interact with external tools, databases, and APIs. Instead of just generating text, the AI can recognize when it needs external information or an action, and will structure the exact request and parameters needed to execute it.

How it work

1. You provide descriptions: You give the AI a list of functions your system supports (weather API) in a structured format like JSON
2. The AI decides and extract: when a user asks a question like, "what's the weather in paris?", The AI realizes it doesn't know. It matches this to your weather function and extracts "Paris" as the required parameter.
3. Execution: Instead of making up an answer, the AI pauses and responds with a structured message saying, "Call the weather function with the argument city='Paris'"

Pros

- Fetch real-time data
- Perform actions: book a flight, schedule a meeting
- Interact with databases: Query an internal company database for a specific customer